

## G10 Consumer Dashboard: May 2026: Real Income Growth Slows in North America

- We update our G10 consumer dashboard through April. G10 consumers generally continue to benefit from healthy balance sheets, but labor markets are more mixed, sentiment has worsened from already low levels following the start of the war in the Middle East, and we expect spending headwinds as higher energy prices erode real incomes in the next few months.
- Household balance sheets remain strong. Household **net worth as a share of income** stands close to all time highs in the US, Japan and Australia, is around percentile 90 (P90) in Canada and the Euro area, and stands around P65 in the UK. Since we last published the dashboard, **real net worth growth** was little changed at P65 in the US and Japan (P65), P50 in the Euro area, and P40 in the UK, Canada and Australia. The saving rate declined to its lowest level since June 2022 in the US, and also declined in Canada (but remains elevated). Elsewhere, the saving rate remains elevated outside of Japan ([Exhibit 10](#)).
- **Consumer sentiment** remains below its historical average across the G10 ([Exhibit 13](#)). In the US, the [University of Michigan's](#) index of consumer sentiment fell to its lowest level in the survey's history—with respondents mentioning that “high prices were eroding their personal finances”—and the [Conference Board](#) index of consumer confidence fell to its lowest level since May 2020, while the expectations component reached its lowest level since October 2011. In [Australia](#), consumer sentiment improved by 3.5% but remains well below its historical average (83.0 vs 100.1).
- Since we last published the dashboard, **real income growth** slowed in the US (P5)—partially reflecting a decline in payments from the Farmer Bridge Assistance program that had boosted personal income in March—and Canada (P20), moved sideways in the Euro area (P95), UK (P40) and Australia (P20) and improved in Japan (near all-time highs). In the [UK](#), private sector pay growth slowed to +3.0% in March (vs. +3.2% in February) below consensus expectations. In [Japan](#), basic wage growth for all workers slowed slightly but remained above 3% (+3.2% in March, vs. +3.4%).
- **Real spending growth** stands below historical averages across DMs, at P15 in Australia, P20 in the US, P35 in Canada, P40 in the Euro area and Japan and P45 in the UK. In [Australia](#), nominal household spending declined by 1.1% mom in April, largely driven by a pullback in transport which the ABS noted “reflected widespread impacts and responses to the conflict in the Middle East”. In the [US](#), real personal spending grew 0.1%, reflecting a 0.2% increase in real services

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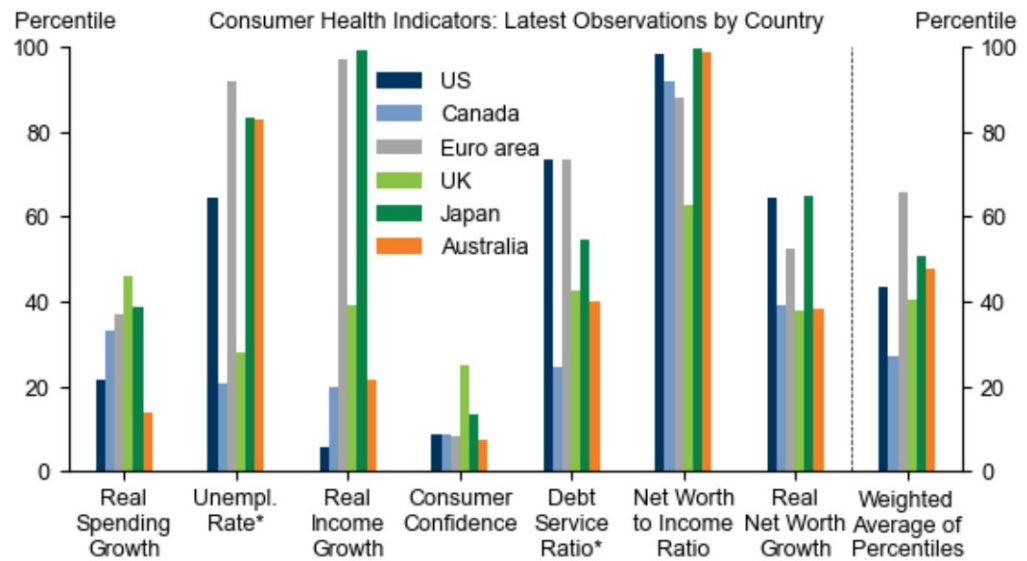
spending but a 0.1% decline in real goods spending. While spending growth has remained resilient so far (with real PCE growth tracking at a healthy 2.1% year-over-year pace through March) we anticipate a slowdown in the months ahead as higher energy prices erode spending power.

- Consumers benefit from healthy labor markets in the Euro area, Australia, and Japan, but labor markets have normalized in the US and are notably weaker in the UK and Canada. The **unemployment rate** is close to its historical low in the Euro area (6.2%), Japan (2.5%), and Australia (4.5%) but stands around P65 in the US (4.3%) P35 in the UK (5.0% 3mma) and P20 in Canada (6.9%). Since we last published the dashboard, the unemployment rate ticked down in the Euro area and Japan, moved sideways in the US and Japan, and increased in the UK, Canada and Australia.
- **Debt service ratios** remain low by historical standards in the US (P75), the Euro area (P75), and Japan (P55) but are higher in Canada (P25), Australia (P40), and the UK (P45). **House prices** continued to decline in Canada (Exhibit 16). Outstanding **mortgage debt** growth stands above its historical averages in the US, Western Europe and Asia, but below in Canada.
- Based on our percentile-based metrics, consumer health stands around **P65** in the **Euro area**, followed by **Japan** and **Australia** around **P50**, the **US** around **P45**, and the **UK** around **P40**. Consumer health is weakest at around **P30** in **Canada**. Since we last published the dashboard, our overall consumer health proxy deteriorated slightly in the UK.
- We continue to expect a deterioration in overall DM consumer health in the next few months due to higher inflation and activity headwinds associated with the war in the Middle East.

## May 2026: Real Income Growth Slows in North America

### Consumer Snapshot

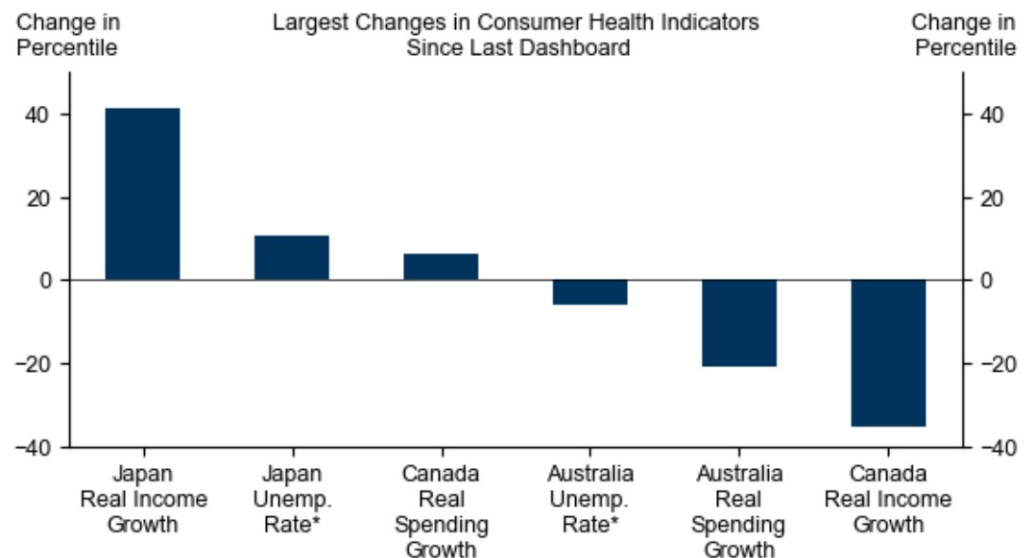
**Exhibit 1: Balance Sheets Remain a Source of Strength, but Sentiment Is Weak**



\* Percentile is inverted. High percentiles correspond to positive outcomes (e.g., low unemployment). We compute the weighted average through April. Variables that are not observed or nowcasted for April are assumed to be unchanged relative to March when taking the average. We have excluded pension assets from UK net worth in measuring the net-worth-to-income ratio as of June 2025, see methodological notes below for further details. We have incorporated Morning Consult's Index of Consumer Sentiment in Canada as of October 2025.

Source: Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Morning Consult

**Exhibit 2: Real Income Growth Slowed in Canada but Improved in Japan; Real Spending Growth Worsened in Australia but Edged Up in Canada**

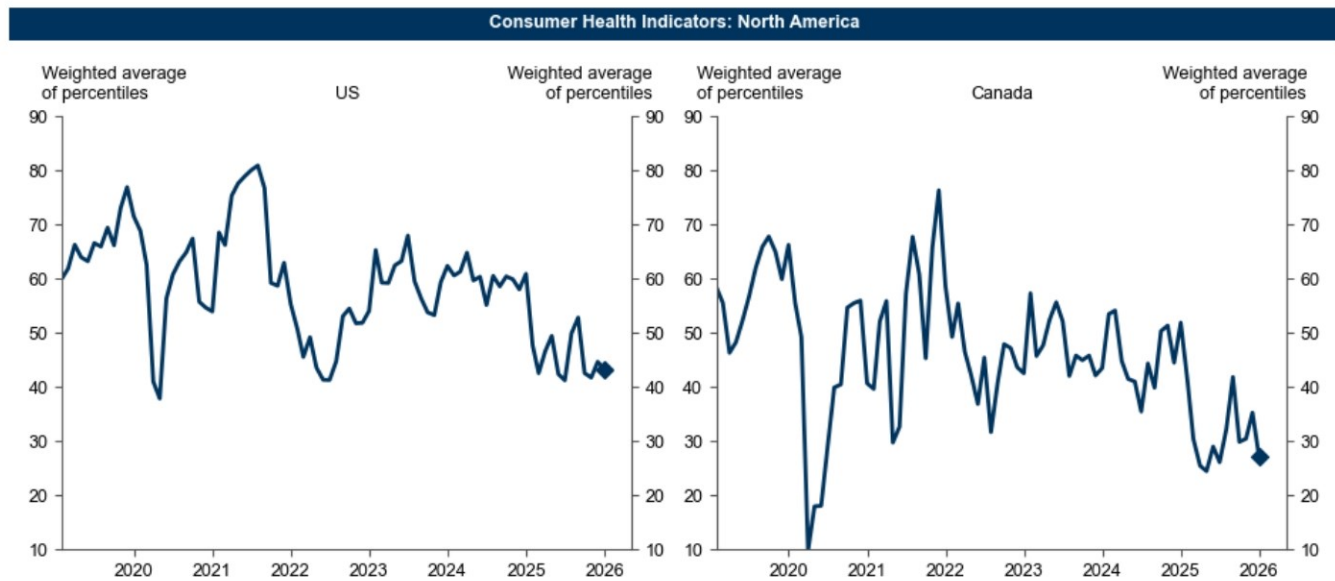


\* Percentile is inverted. High percentiles correspond to positive outcomes (i.e. low unemployment).

Source: Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

## Consumer Health Trends

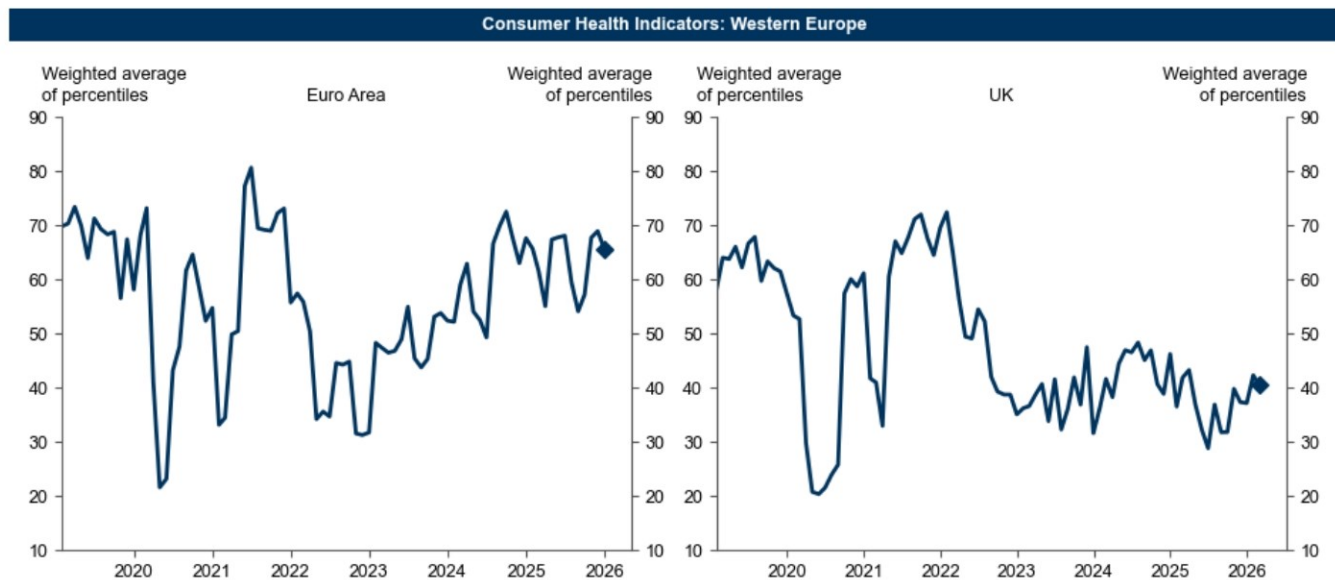
**Exhibit 3: Our Consumer Health Indicator Stands Around P45 in the US and P25 in Canada**



We compute the weighted average through April. Variables that are not observed or nowcasted for April are assumed to be unchanged relative to March when taking the average.

Source: Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

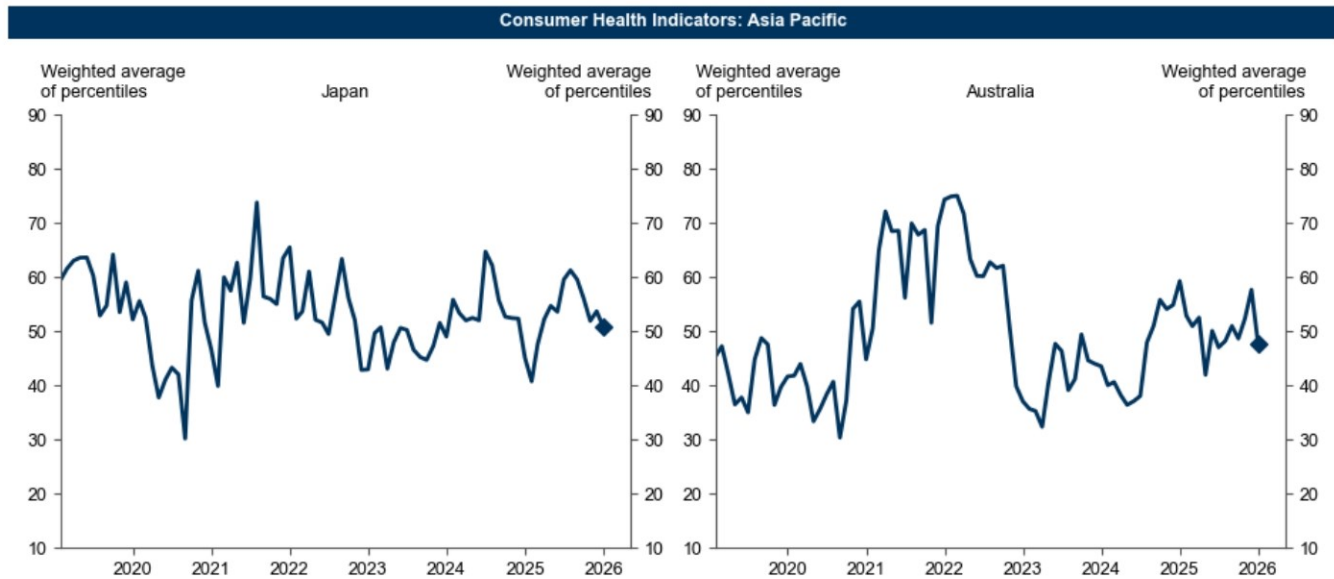
**Exhibit 4: Our Consumer Health Indicator Stands Around P65 in the Euro Area and P35 in the UK**



We compute the weighted average through April. Variables that are not observed or nowcasted for April are assumed to be unchanged relative to March when taking the average.

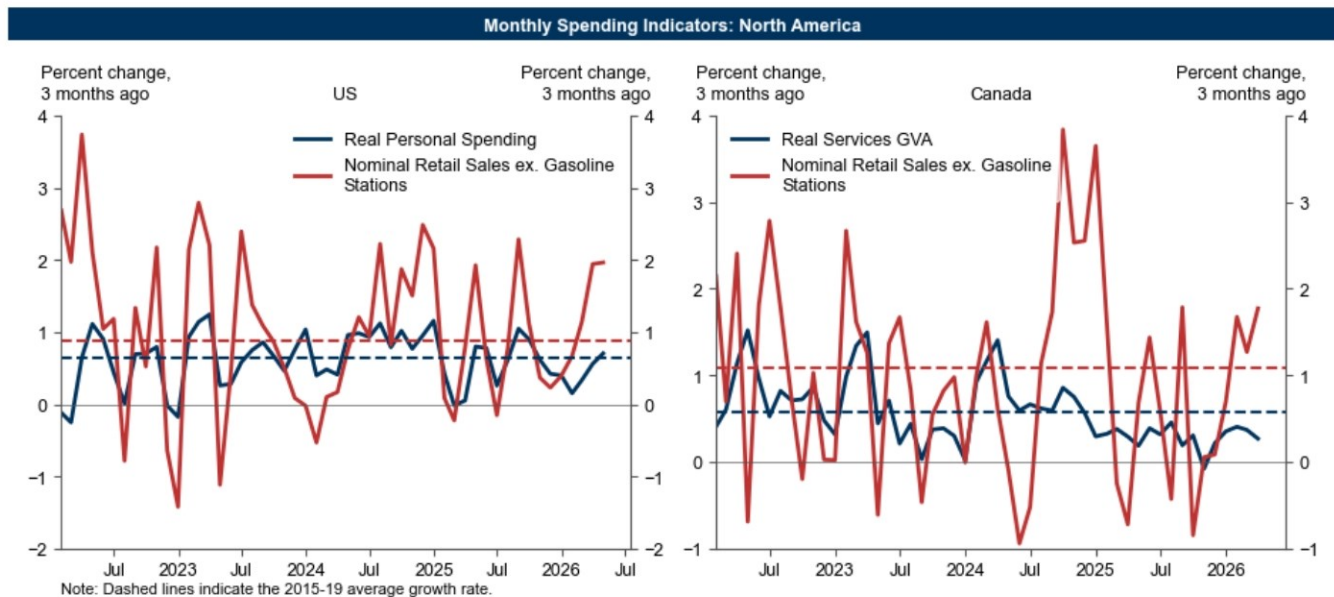
Source: Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research



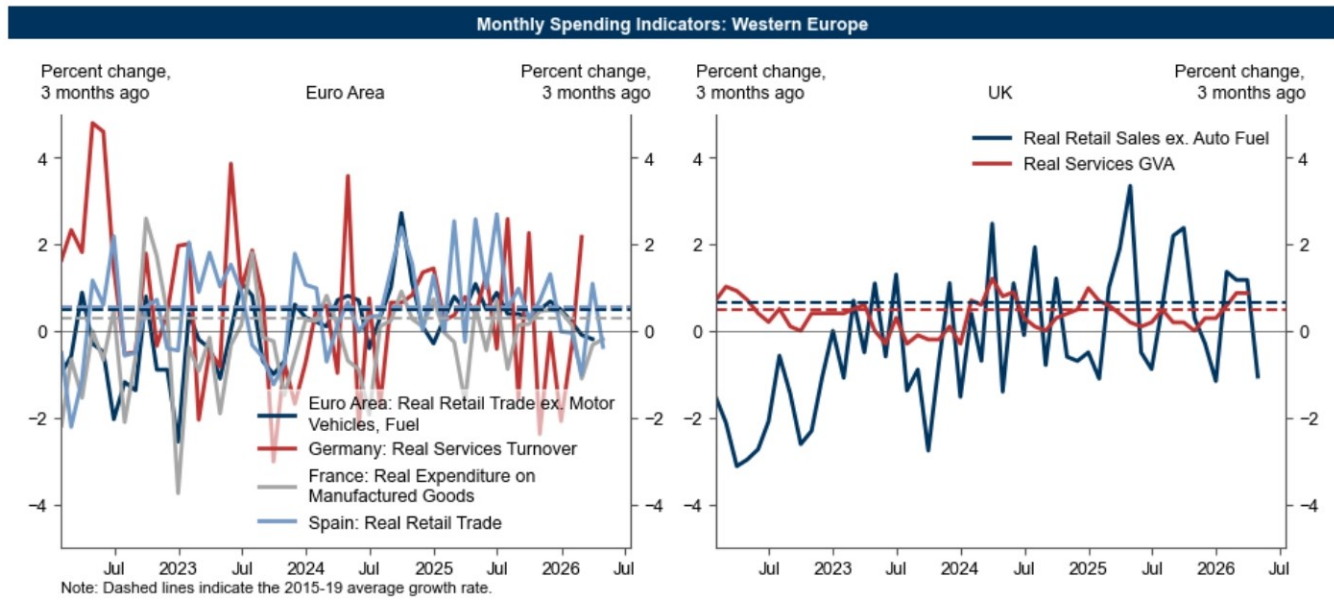
**Exhibit 5: Our Consumer Health Indicator Stands Around P50 in Japan and Australia**

We compute the weighted average through April. Variables that are not observed or nowcasted for April are assumed to be unchanged relative to March when taking the average.

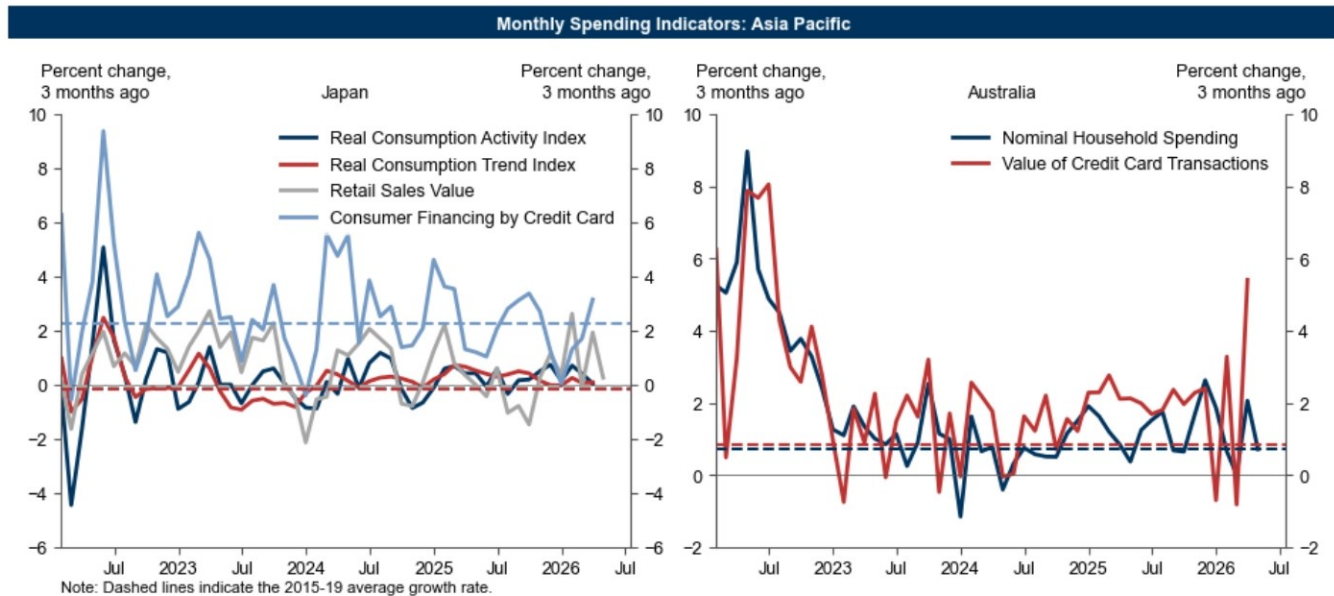
Source: Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

**Spending Indicators****Exhibit 6: Real Spending Growth Stands Close to Its Historical Mean in the US but Real Services GVA Growth Remains Subdued in Canada**

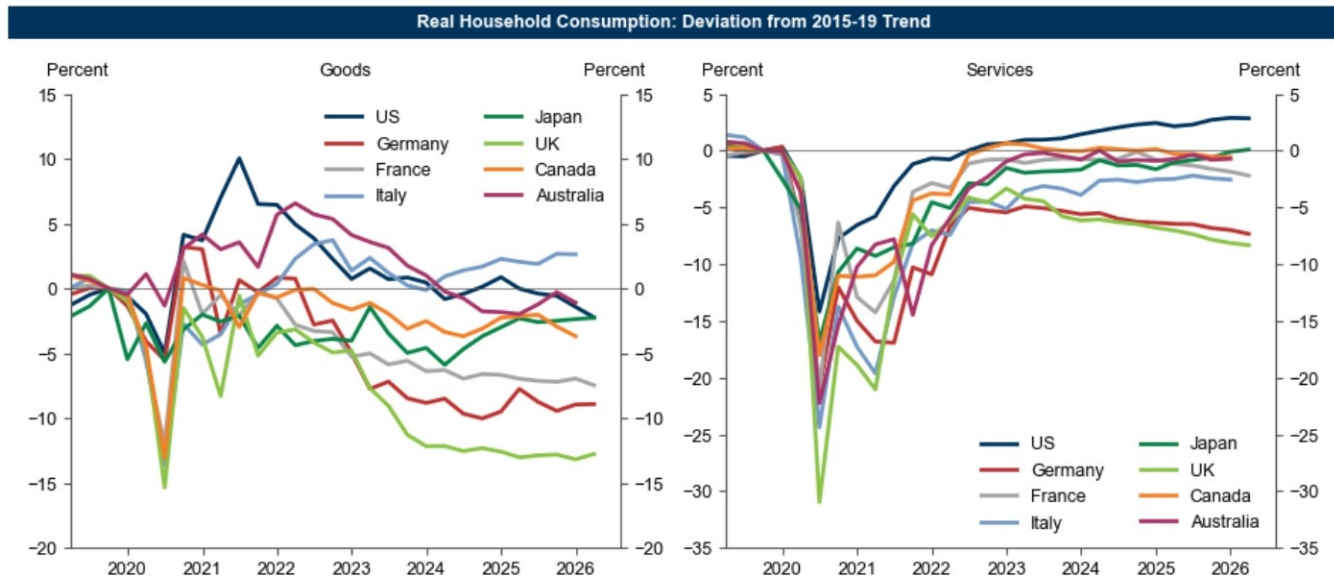
Source: Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

**Exhibit 7: Real Retail Sales Growth Is Negative in the Euro Area and UK**

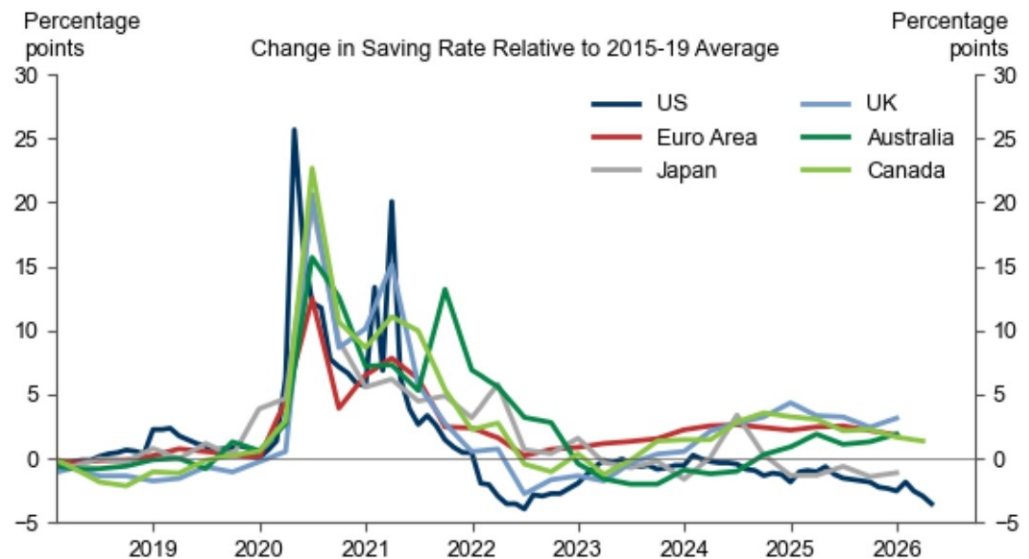
Source: Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

**Exhibit 8: Nominal Spending Growth Slowed in Japan and Australia, and Stands Close to Its Pre-Pandemic Trends**

Source: Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

**Exhibit 9: Spending On Both Goods and Services Remains Depressed in the UK and Germany**

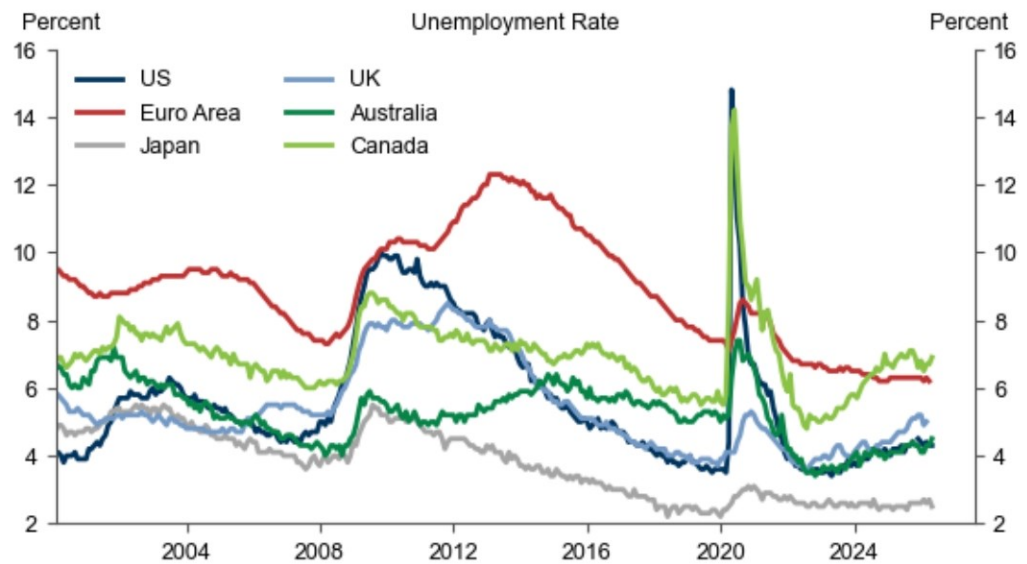
Source: Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

**Exhibit 10: The Saving Rate Ticked Down in the US and Canada**

Source: Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

## Labor-Market Indicators

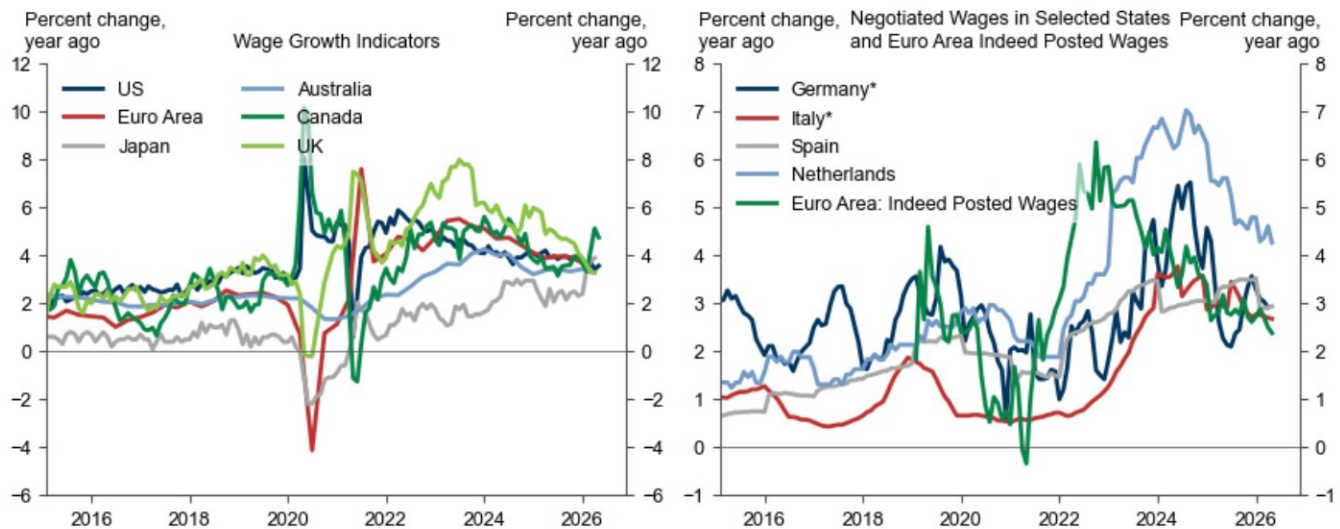
**Exhibit 11: The Unemployment Rate Ticked Up in the UK, Canada Australia but Ticked Down in Japan and the Euro Area**



\*The UK labor force survey has notably low participation rates.

Source: Haver Analytics, OECD, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

**Exhibit 12: Wage Growth Accelerated in Japan but Ticked Down from Elevated Levels (Due to Compositional Distortions) in Canada**



\*We take the 6mma of the negotiated wages in Germany and Italy to correct for high volatility from one-off payments.

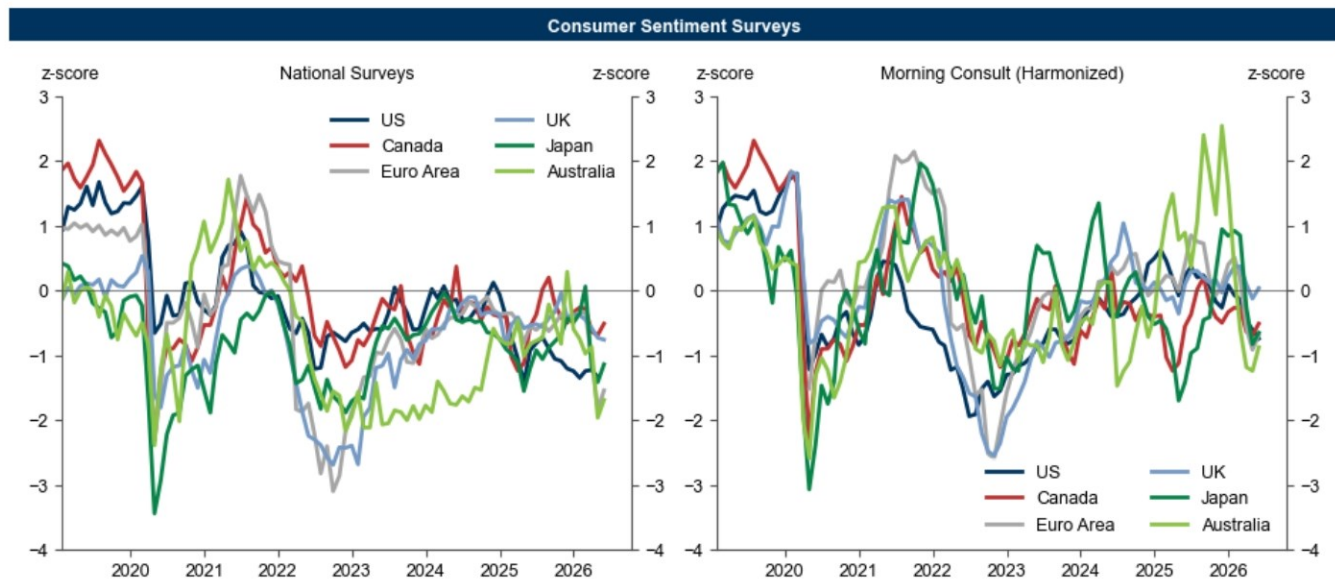
We consider AHE for total private industries in the US, compensation per employee in the Euro area, contractual earnings index per FT employee in Japan, AWE (regular pay) for the whole economy in the UK, the quarterly wage price index in Australia, and average hourly wages of permanent employees in Canada. We consider negotiated hourly earnings ex one-off payments in Germany, contractual wages per employee in Italy, agreed wage from collective bargaining in Spain and monthly wage incl. special payments from collective bargaining in the Netherlands. The Euro area Indeed posted wage growth is a new indicator of wage growth based on wages and salaries posted in Indeed job ads, which is a more timely indicator of wage growth for new hires.

Source: Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research



## Consumer Sentiment Indicators

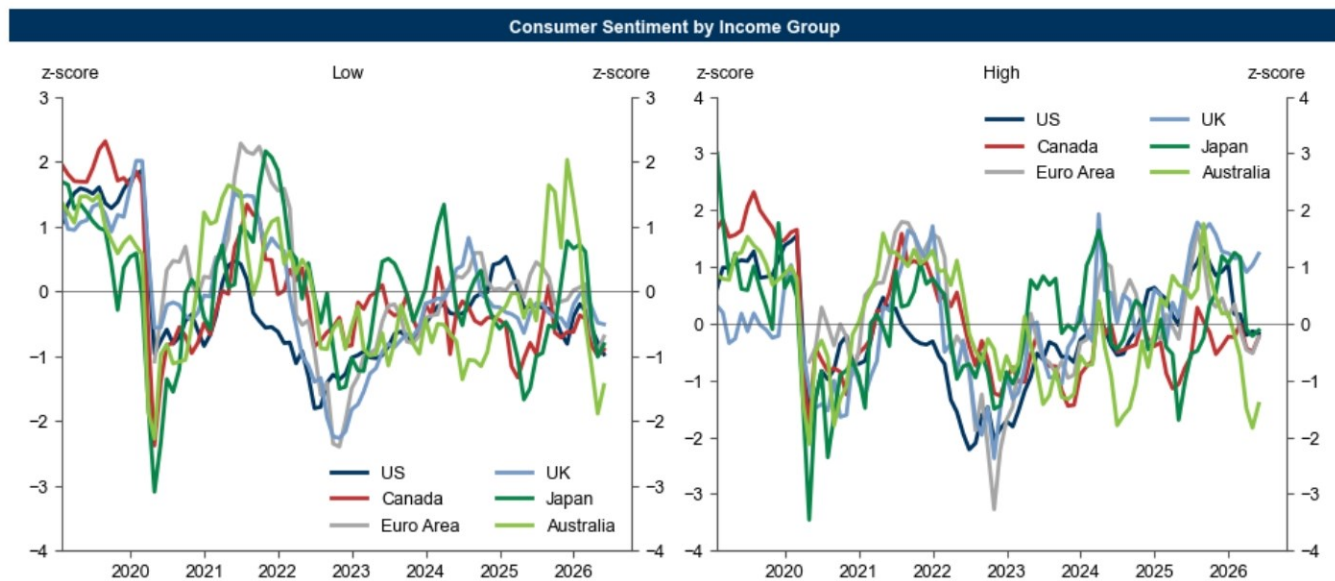
**Exhibit 13: Morning Consult's High Frequency Measure of Consumer Sentiment Recovered Slightly in April but Remains Depressed Amid the War in the Middle East**



In each country we consider the most prominent survey-based indicator of consumer confidence. These are the UMich Consumer Sentiment and the Conference Board Consumer Confidence in the US, the European Commission Consumer Confidence Indicator in the Euro area, the GfK Consumer Confidence Barometer in the UK, the Cabinet Office's Consumer Confidence Index in Japan, and the Westpac-Melbourne Institute's Consumer Sentiment Index in Australia. In Canada, we use Morning Consult's Index of Consumer Sentiment (MC ICS) given a lack of data. To construct the Euro Area composite of the MC ICS we take a GDP-weighted average of the indices for Germany, France, Italy and Spain.

Source: Haver Analytics, Morning Consult, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

**Exhibit 14: Sentiment Is Weakest in Australia for Both Low- and High-Income Consumers**

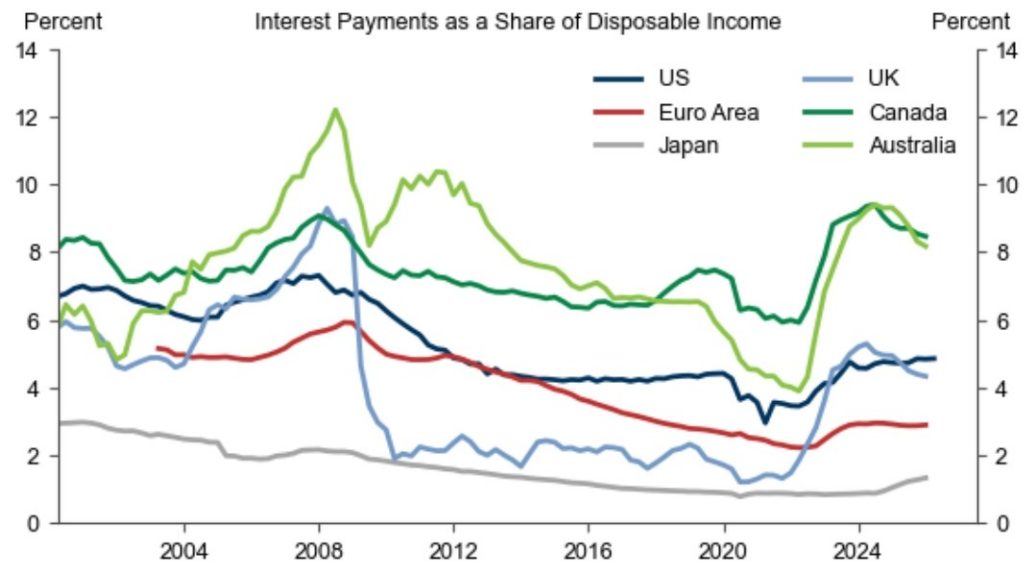


In each country, we use Morning Consult's Index of Consumer Sentiment, disaggregated by income. To construct the Euro Area composite of the MC ICS we take a GDP-weighted average of the indices for Germany, France, Italy and Spain. The low and high income groups correspond to <\$50k and >\$100k in the US, <C\$40k and >C\$100k in Canada, <€40k and >€100k in Germany and France, <€30k and >€100k in Italy and Spain, <¥6m and >¥12m in Japan and <A\$60k and >A\$125k in Australia.

Source: Morning Consult, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

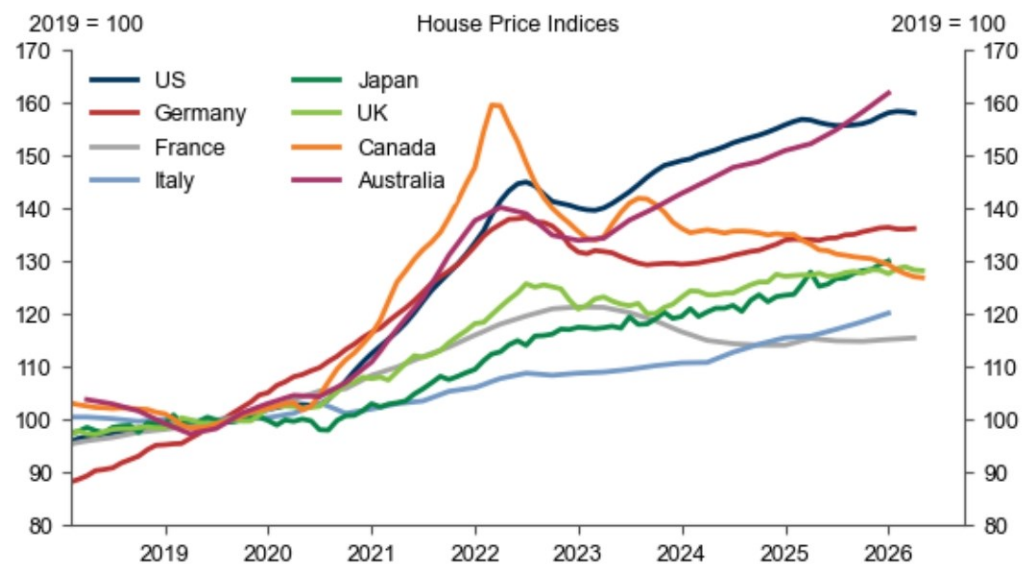
## Financial Indicators

**Exhibit 15: Interest Expenses Remain Elevated in Canada and Australia**



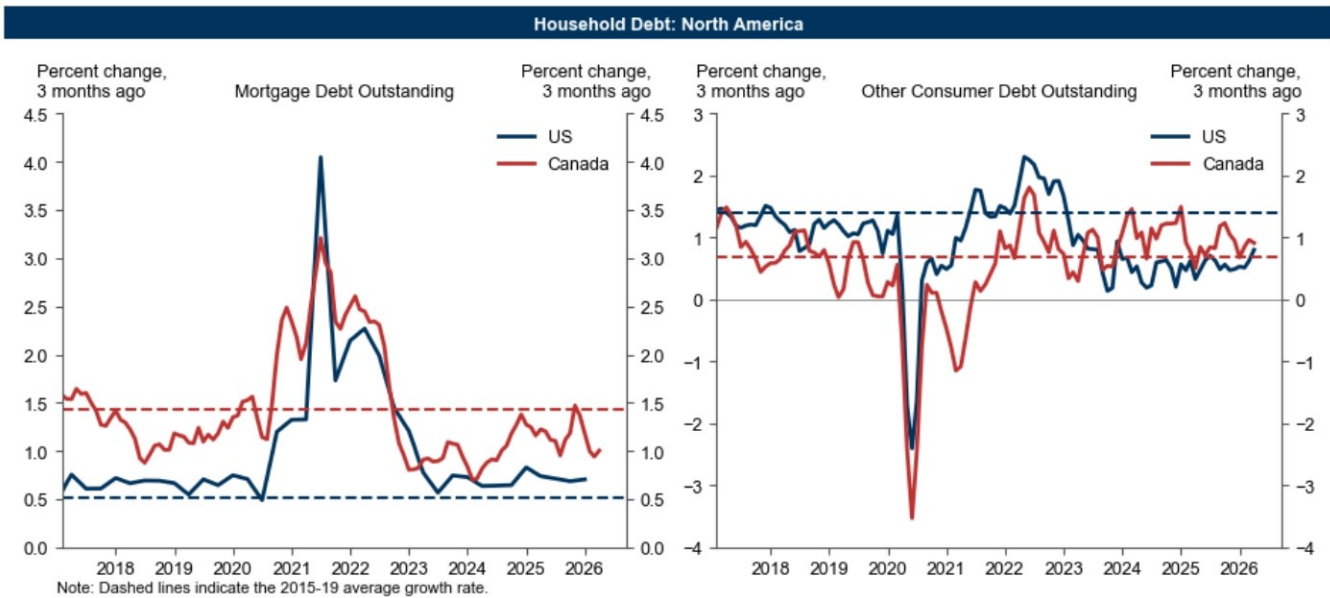
Source: Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

**Exhibit 16: House Prices Continue to Decline in Canada**



We consider the S&P CoreLogic Case-Shiller HPI for existing single-family residential homes in the US, the residential property price index by the Ministry of Land, Infrastructure Transport and Tourism in Japan, the Hypoport HPI in Germany, the INS HPI for houses and apartments in France, the Istat HPI in Italy, the Halifax national HPI for all houses in the UK, the RBA's mean value of residential dwellings in Australia, and the CREA MLS benchmark price in Canada.

Source: Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

**Exhibit 17: Outstanding Household Debt Was Little Changed in North America**

On the right-hand side, we consider consumer credit in the US and household non-mortgage debt in Canada.

Source: Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

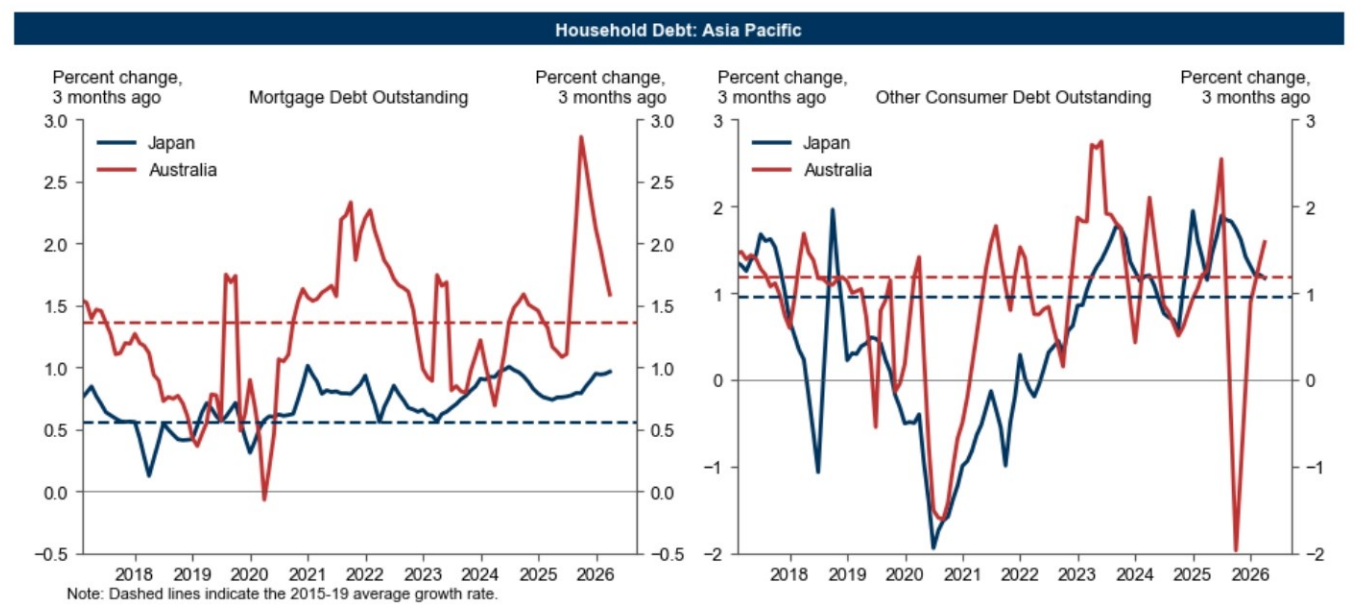
**Exhibit 18: Outstanding Mortgage Debt Growth Ticked Up in the UK**

On the right-hand side, we consider consumer credit in the Euro area and consumer credit (ex student loans) in the UK.

Source: Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research



Exhibit 19: Growth in Mortgage and Other Consumer Debt Stands Above Trend in Japan and Australia

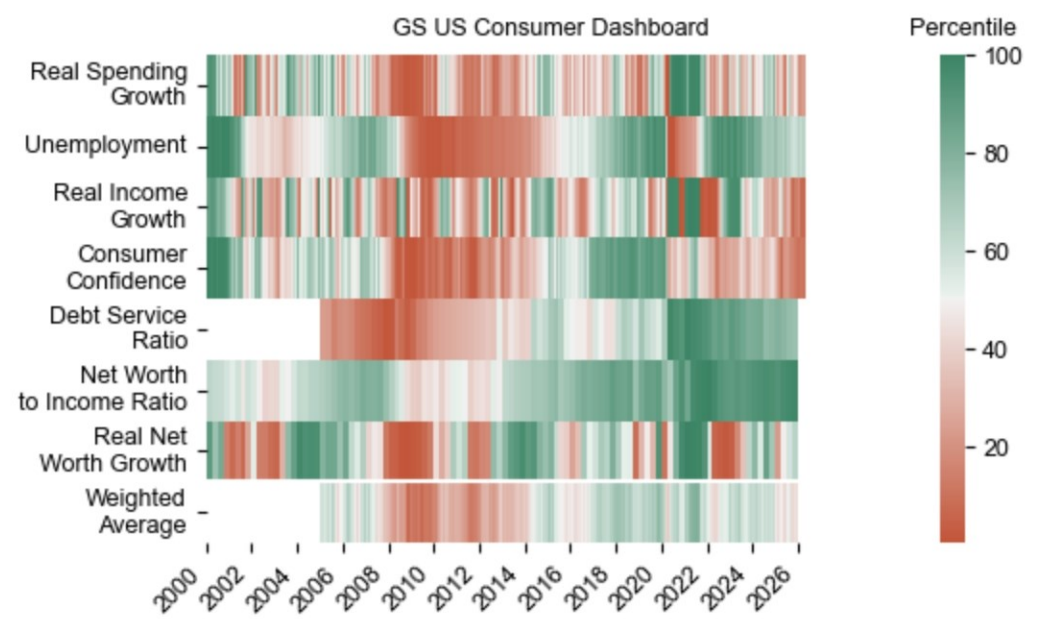


On the right-hand side, we consider consumer credit in Japan and non-mortgage household debt in Australia.

Source: Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Consumer Dashboards

Exhibit 20: In the US, Household Balance Sheets Remain Healthy and Debt Service Ratios Low by Historical Standards, Although Sentiment and Spending Growth Are Weaker

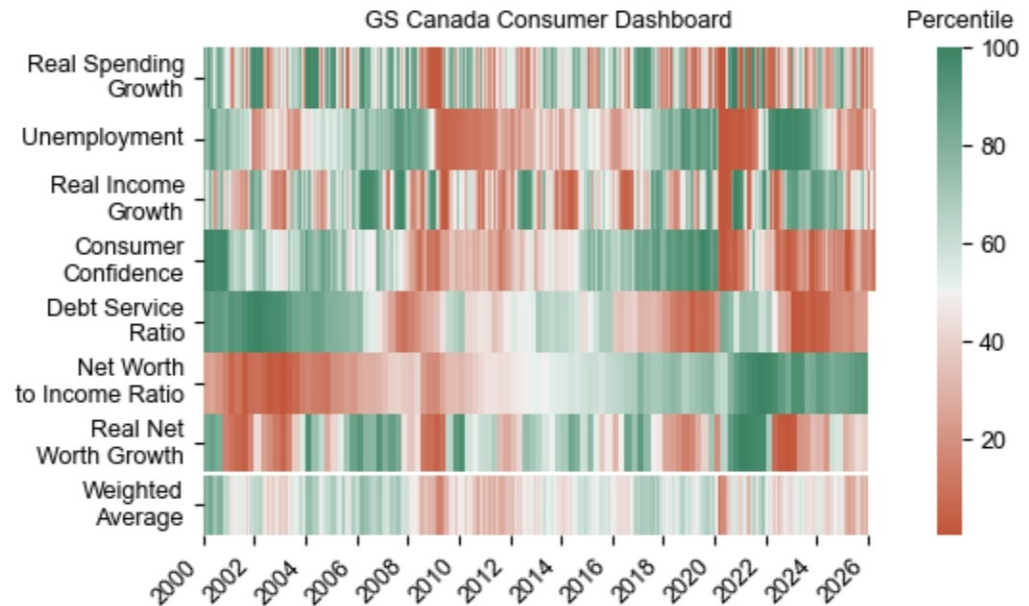


We compute the weighted average through April. Variables that are not observed or nowcasted for April are assumed to be unchanged relative to March when taking the average.

Source: Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research



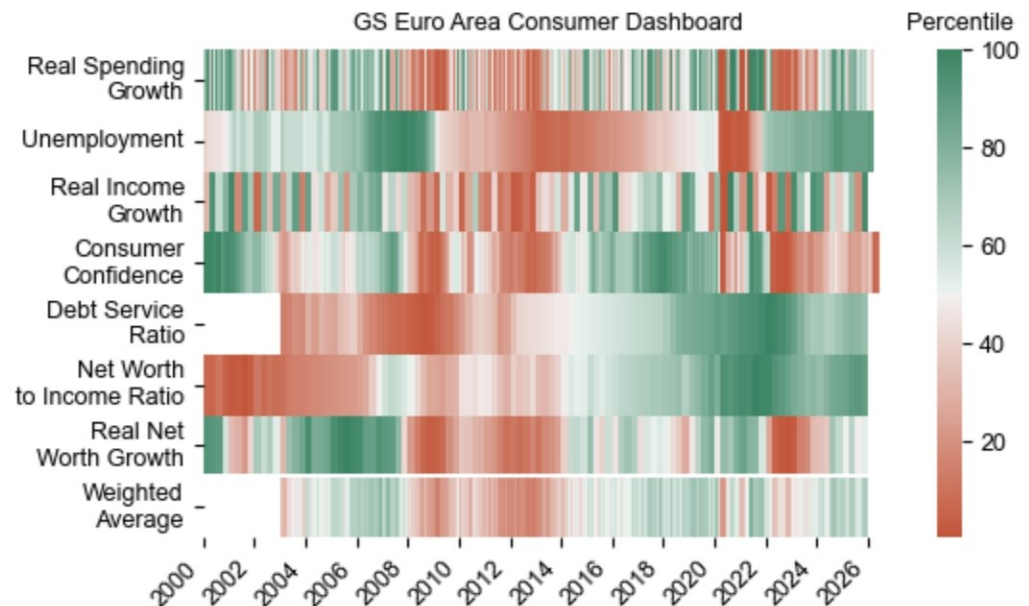
**Exhibit 21: In Canada, Consumer Confidence Remains Weak and Real Income Growth Has Deteriorated, but Net-Worth-to-Income Remains High by Historical Standards**



We compute the weighted average through April. Variables that are not observed or nowcasted for April are assumed to be unchanged relative to March when taking the average.

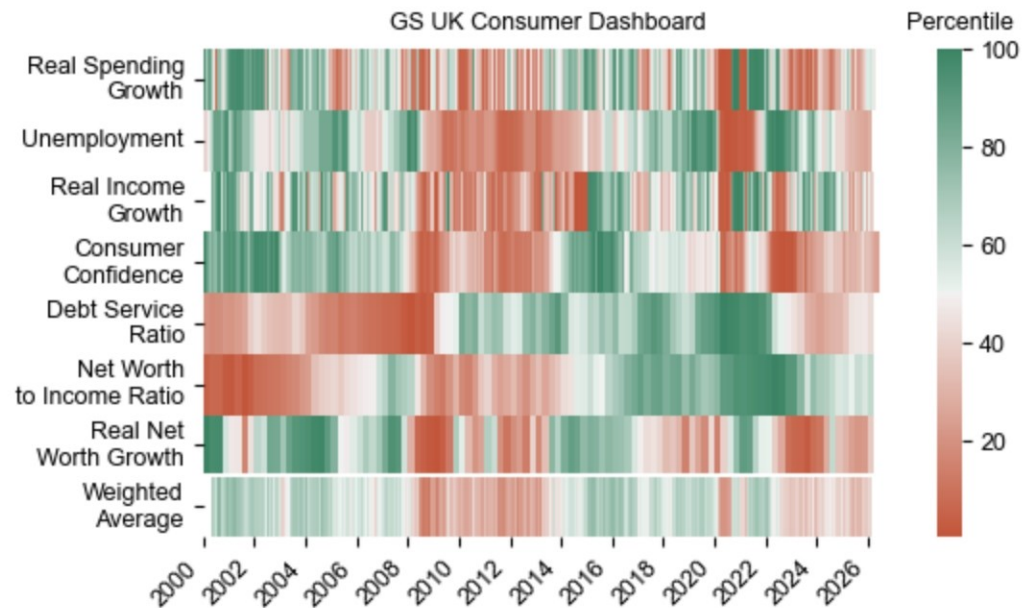
Source: Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

**Exhibit 22: In the Euro Area, the Labor Market Remains Tight and Balance Sheets Healthy by Historical Standards**



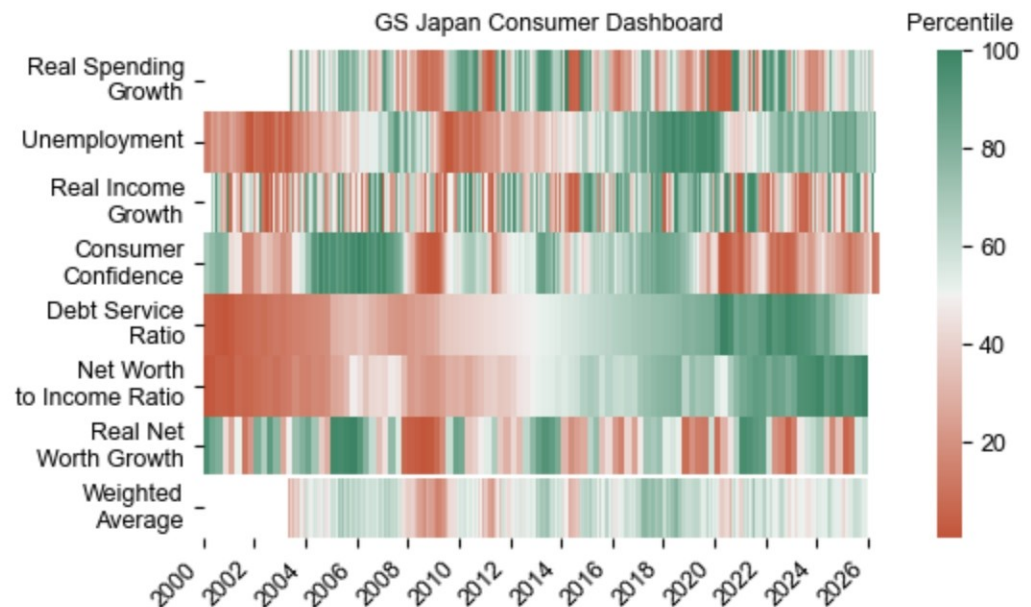
We compute the weighted average through April. Variables that are not observed or nowcasted for April are assumed to be unchanged relative to March when taking the average.

Source: Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

**Exhibit 23: In the UK, the Labor Market Remains Soft and Sentiment Subdued**

We compute the weighted average through April. Variables that are not observed or nowcasted for April are assumed to be unchanged relative to March when taking the average.

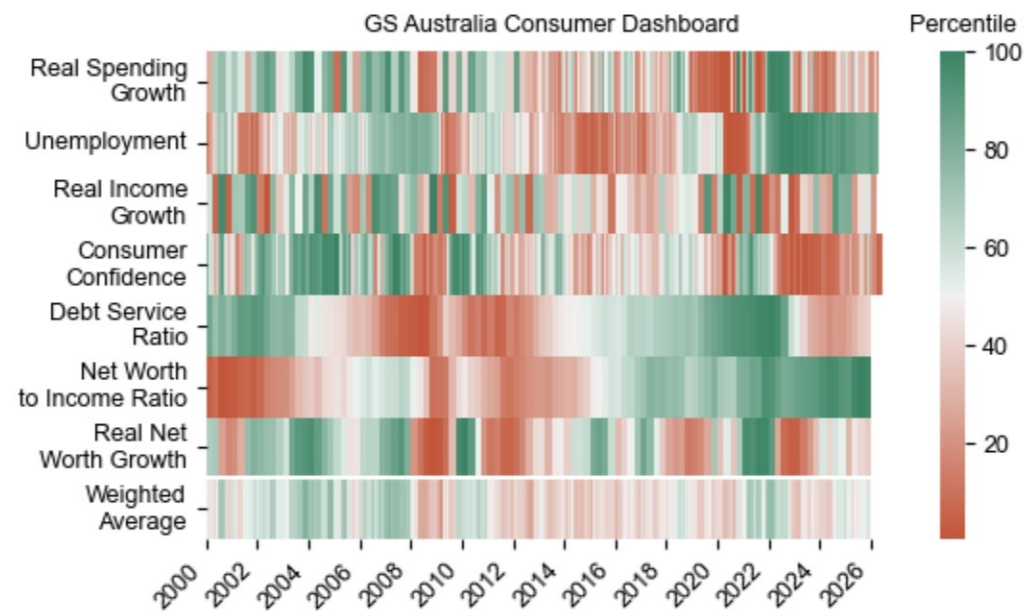
Source: Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

**Exhibit 24: In Japan, the Labor Market Remains Tight and the Net-Worth-to-Income Ratio High by Historical Standards**

We compute the weighted average through April. Variables that are not observed or nowcasted for April are assumed to be unchanged relative to March when taking the average.

Source: Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

**Exhibit 25: In Australia, the Net-Worth-to-Income Ratio and the Labor Market Remain Healthy by Historical Standards**



We compute the weighted average through April. Variables that are not observed or nowcasted for April are assumed to be unchanged relative to March when taking the average.

Source: Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

## Data Appendix

1. For the US, we maintain the framework introduced in our US consumer dashboard. Outside of the US, we identify the closest and most timely measures of consumer health available in each country.
2. **Real spending growth:** In the US, we consider six-month real personal consumption expenditure growth. In the Euro area, the UK, and Canada, we measure month-on-month growth in real retail sales. In Canada, the most recent value of real retail sales is nowcasted using Statcan's flash estimates. In Australia, we use the monthly nominal spending indicator, deflated by monthly CPI ex. volatile items and adjusted for housing costs. In Japan, we consider the average between the real consumption activity index and the real consumption trend. To address the volatility of monthly moves, we compute the 6-month moving average (6m MA).
3. **Unemployment:** We consider the gap between the monthly unemployment rate and OECD NAIRU estimates. In the Euro area and the UK (where furlough schemes limited the rise of unemployment during lockdowns), we apply an adjustment for hours worked during the pandemic.
4. **Real income growth:** We measure month-on-month growth in real aggregate labor earnings combining data, for instance, on hours worked and hourly earnings. Where available, we combine this with survey-based measures of household income, which help capture fluctuations in non-labor income sources. We again compute the 6m MA to address concerns over large swings in month on month data releases. In the Euro area and Australia, we consider quarterly growth in real disposable income and nowcast it when the most recent quarter is not yet released.
5. **Consumer confidence:** In each country, we consider the most prominent survey-based indicator of consumer confidence. These are the UMich Consumer Sentiment and the Conference Board Consumer Confidence in the US, the European Commission Consumer Confidence Indicator in the Euro area, the GfK Consumer Confidence Barometer in the UK, the Cabinet Office's Consumer Confidence Index in Japan, and the Westpac-Melbourne Institute's Consumer Sentiment Index in Australia. In Canada, we use Morning Consult's Index of Consumer Sentiment, which we backcast by projecting onto the US UMich index (which uses a harmonized set of questions) given a lack of national data.
6. **Net worth to income ratio:** We consider the ratio of household net worth (inclusive of housing) and disposable income. When the observation for the most recent quarter is not yet available, we nowcast it with a linear regression model featuring predictors available at higher frequency (e.g., changes in home prices and equity prices). As of the June 2025 publication we have removed all pension assets from the measure of UK net worth in an effort to harmonize the net-worth-to-income ratio measures across G10 counterparts. We are comfortable with this change given that pension assets are among the most illiquid forms of wealth, and the UK pension assets have seen a substantive and persistent devaluation that stood out as an outlier when compared to other G10 countries.
7. **Debt service ratio:** We consider the ratio of household interest payments and



disposable income. When the observation for the most recent quarter is not yet available, we nowcast it with a regression model featuring higher frequency predictors.

8. **Real net worth growth:** We consider the year-on-year growth rate of real household net worth (inclusive of housing). When the observation for the most recent quarter is not yet available, we nowcast it with a regression model. As of the June 2025 publication we have removed all pension assets from the measure of UK net worth in an effort to harmonize the real net worth growth measures across G10 counterparts. We are comfortable with this change given that pension assets are among the most illiquid forms of wealth, and the UK pension assets have seen a substantive and persistent devaluation that stood out as an outlier when compared to other G10 countries.
9. For all components and non-US economies, we plot the percentile rank of each observation in the country's distribution since 2000. In the US, percentiles are computed since 1980, consistent with our US consumer dashboard.
10. For the unemployment gap and debt service ratio, we consider the inverted percentile rank such that high percentiles correspond to positive outcomes (i.e. low unemployment gaps and low debt service ratios).
11. **Weighted average of percentiles:** We compute the weighted average of percentiles with weights based on frequency, timeliness, and volatility of the indicator. We compute the weighted average through June. Variables that are not observed or nowcasted for June are assumed to be unchanged relative to May when taking the average. The weights are 20% on real spending growth, 20% on the unemployment gap, 20% on consumer confidence, 15% on real income growth, 10% on debt service ratio, 10% on real net worth growth, and 5% on net worth to income ratio.

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## Disclosure Appendix

### Reg AC

I, Megan Peters, hereby certify that all of the views expressed in this report accurately reflect my personal views, which have not been influenced by considerations of the firm's business or client relationships.

Unless otherwise stated, the individuals listed on the cover page of this report are analysts in Goldman Sachs' Global Investment Research division.

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